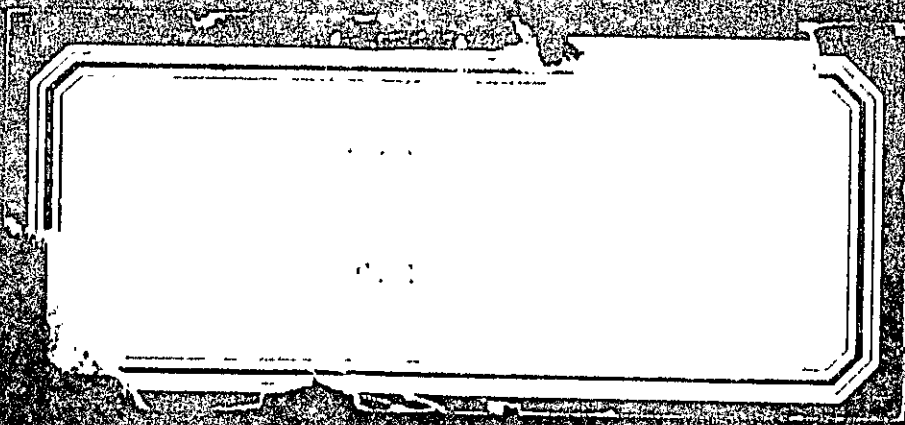


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AUTH: ROBERT J. FRIEND, MAJOR, USAF

By Robert J. Friend, Major (AFR 205-1D)
Signature and Grade

Date 9 SEPT 1960

STATUS REPORT NO. 1

PROJECT GRUDGE

RETURN TO
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ATTN: Archives Branch
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K242.6012
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30 November 1951

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AUTH: ROBERT J. FRIEND, MAJOR, USAF

By Robert J. Friend, Major
Signature and Grade

Date 9 SEPT 1960

AIR TECHNICAL INTELLIGENCE CENTER
WRIGHT-PATTERSON AIR FORCE BASE
DAYTON, OHIO

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AUTH: ROBERT J. FRIEND, MAJOR USAF

By Robert J. Friend, Major
Signature and Grade

Date 9 SEPT 1960

This report is the first of a series of monthly status reports of Project Grudge. Each report will be written on or near the last day of the month and will contain a list of all incidents reported during the month covered by the report. The reports that are considered to be outstanding will also be summarized in the appendices of the report so that more details can be presented. The overall status of the project will also be presented.

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STATUS OF PROJECT GRUDGE

I. Overall Status

Much of the work done on Project Grudge has been devoted to the reorganization of the project as given in the Project Initiation Form A-3, dated 22 October 1951.

The old Project Grudge and Project Sign files have been reviewed and sorted. Cross-indexing and tabulation of the old files has been slow due to a lack of clerical help, but it is hoped that this situation will be alleviated in the near future. It is contemplated that all of the sightings of unconventional flying objects will soon be cross-indexed according to size, color, location, etc., so that as much statistical data as possible will be available. It is believed that it may be possible to determine several general characteristics of the sightings from the mass of data that is on file at ATIC.

Contacts have been established with all agencies that may be able to assist in Project Grudge such as Air Weather Service, Flight Service, high altitude balloon projects, O.S.I., etc. There is still some doubt as to the channels that should be used in contacting some agencies but these will be clarified in the near future.

Two major difficulties have arisen and they are (1) the time element and (2) obtaining transportation. In regard to the time element, it has been found that in many instances one or two months will elapse before ATIC receives word on an incident. It is very possible that many incidents are never reported. As far as can be determined, this is due to two main reasons:

a. Letters pertaining to the procedures and responsibilities in reporting incidents were dated September 1950. Since that time there has been an influx of new and recalled officers and changes in personnel; consequently, a great number of people are not aware of the requirements of Project Grudge. Incidents that are several months old are finally received at ATIC after having forwarded through several commands.

b. It is believed that the general feeling in some instances is that the Air Force is not too interested in this project and reporting such incidents is unimportant. It is the opinion of ATIC that regardless of personal beliefs as to the origin of the objects, the task of determining, if possible, what these objects are has been assigned, and should be carried out.

It is believed that the revision and re-circulation of the AF letter pertaining to Project Grudge will alleviate the problem of delay in receiving reports. The Collection Division, Directorate of Intelligence, was requested to revise and re-circulate this letter on 25 October 1951.

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If, after the above mentioned letter is circulated, the situation does not improve, it may be advisable to circulate another memorandum explaining why the Air Force is interested in this problem and how reports are to be made.

The second major difficulty encountered has been transportation in the locality of the incidents. On many occasions, the interrogation of one source will lead to other sources. All of these "leads" must be followed to get a complete picture. This necessitates a great deal of travel within a city or even over part of a state. At times government transportation is available but at other times the incidents are not close to military establishments or if they are, all transportation may be in use. Since it is the policy not to reimburse travelers for such taxi fares, this has imposed a great financial burden on the investigator. In regard to the same subject, the time element again enters since there is usually only a limited amount of time that can be spent on an investigation and all the time spent attempting to get transportation or finding the correct bus routes is lost.

Steps have been taken to overcome this second major difficulty by requesting that Headquarters USAF send a wire to the military installation to which a visit will be made requesting that the Commanding Officer give full cooperation to Project Grudge personnel.

Another problem that has not been fully investigated is whether or not wide spread publicity to the project should be given in an attempt to obtain a more complete coverage of incidents. It is believed that more reports would be obtained but the publicity would also produce a mass of "crank" letters that would increase the workload a considerable amount. It has been tentatively decided that the best course of action is to wait and see what improvements are brought about by the revised AF letters being re-circulated by the Collection Division of D/I.

II. Reports of Specific Incidents

The inclosed list is a summary of all incidents that have been reported or were being investigated during the period 22 October 1951 to 30 November 1951. Several of the incidents are considered too detailed to summarize in the list so they are carried over and summarized in the appendices.

In the future, the list will consist of two parts: (1) incidents reported during the period covered by the report, and (2) incidents from the past period that are still in the process of being investigated or incidents that are pending during the previous month and are now closed.

Due to the huge task of investigating all reported incidents, it will be the policy of Project Grudge to concentrate on those incidents that appear to have originated from high grade sources, such as pilots, technically trained people, etc. The only exception to this will be where a number of sightings occur in a certain area at about the same time. All reports, however, will be incorporated in the file for statistical purposes.

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In the evaluation of reported radar sightings, the Electronics Section of ATIC has been consulted. The majority of the radar sightings are very difficult to evaluate due to the possibility of phenomena caused by weather or in the electronic circuits of the set. About all that can be concluded on these sightings is the weather was or was not conducive to promoting phenomena known to be caused by certain weather conditions.

In certain instances special detailed reports will be written on the conclusions of the investigations of sightings. These will be in compliance with requests from higher headquarters for such reports. The conclusions of all other incidents will be concluded in the status report.

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DATE	TIME (Local)	LOCATION	DESCRIPTION
25 Aug 51	2110	Lubbock, Texas	Group of lights that have been seen on many occasions.
25 Aug 51	2158	Albuquerque, N. Mex.	Dark flying wing type aircraft with about 1 1/2 engines.
26 Aug 51	0118	Ellington AFB, Texas	Bright yellow light making a zig-zag course through the clouds.
26 Aug 51	0300	Ellington AFB, Texas	Erratic yellow light.
26 Aug 51	0828	Larson AFB, Wash.	Radar sighting - Aircraft were scrambled but found negative. (See Appendix III)
26 Aug 51	1658	San Antonio, Tex.	Large object resembling a delta wing aircraft.
27 Aug 51	2000	Vandalia, Ill.	Bright orange light seen from the ground and a few minutes later.
29 Aug 51	1530	Grenier AFB, N.H.	Two silvery objects connected by a dark unidentified object then rose and disappeared.
31 Aug 51	1245	Matador, Texas	Pear-shaped aluminum object seen to hover then rise and disappear.
3 Sept 51	2220	Spokane, Wash.	Bluish white light with fiery trail. About the size of a football.
6 Sept 51	1120	Claremont, Calif.	Two groups of orange colored objects were seen in the second.
3 Sept 51	1400	Spokane, Wash.	Three objects appeared out of the N.W. Appeared to be of the same type.
8 Sept 51	1400	Spokane, Wash.	Bluish white light about the size of an automobile.
10 Sept 51	1110	Ft Monmouth, N. J.	Radar return - Fast moving, low flying target on a course (See Appendix VI).
10 Sept 51	1135	Ft Monmouth, N. J.	Pilots in T-33 aircraft attempted to intercept but failed. (See Appendix VI)
10 Sept 51	1515	Ft Monmouth, N. J.	Radar return - High, moving target observed.
10 Sept 51	2100	Goose AFB, Newfoundland	Radar return - GCA radar observed two objects on a course.
11 Sept 51	1050	Ft Monmouth, N. J.	Radar return - Two radar sets picked up high speed target.

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DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT

of lights that have been seen on many occasions (See Appendix I).

lying wing type aircraft with about 1 1/2 times the wing span of a B-36 (See Appendix II).

yellow light making a zig-zag course through the sky.

yellow light.

ighting - Aircraft were scrambled but failed to make contact. Visual search results
tive. (See Appendix III)

object resembling a delta wing aircraft.

orange light seen from the ground and again from two aircraft (See Appendix IV).

lvery objects connected by a dark unidentified body. First appeared to descent slowly,
ose and disappeared.

naped aluminum object seen to hover then leave the area at high speed (See Appendix V).

white light with fiery trail. About the size of an automobile headlight.

oups of orange colored objects were seen. Six objects were in the first group and one
second.

objects appeared out of the N.W. Appeared to be a disk when viewed through a monocular.

white light about the size of an automobile headlight leaving a fiery trail.

return - Fast moving, low flying target observed paralleling the coast on a northerly
(See Appendix VI).

in T-33 aircraft attempted to intercept unknown object with negative results
ppendix VI)

return - High, moving target observed. (See Appendix VI)

return - GCA radar observed two objects near the airfield.

return - Two radar sets picked up high target. (See Appendix VI).

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INCIDENT	LENGTH OF TIME OBSERVED	SOUND	SPEED	
ns (See Appendix I).	4 Sec.	None	30° arc/sec	Un
as the wing span of a B-36 (See Appendix II).	30 Sec.	None	300-400 mph	10
the sky.	Unknown	None	High	H
	1 hour plus	None	Slow	H
to make contact. Visual search results.	8 Min.	None	948 mph	1
	10 Sec.	None	Very high	Ve
from two aircraft (See Appendix IV).	Unknown	None	High	Un
ed body. First appeared to descent slowly,	Unknown	None	Slow	10
the area at high speed (See Appendix V).	Several seconds	None	Hovering to high speed	La
of an automobile headlight.	Seconds	None	High	La
objects were in the first group and one	3-4 Min	None	Unknown	H
be a disk when viewed through a monocular.	3-4 Min	None	Erratic	U
headlight leaving a fiery trail.	Seconds	None	High	L
ved paralleling the coast on a northerly	Several minutes	None	High	L
unknown object with negative results	2 Min	None	High	8
Appendix VI)	Several minutes	None	Low	9
the airfield.	Several minutes	None	140 mph	1
(See Appendix VI).	Several minutes	None	Slow	2

OUND	SPEED	ALTITUDE	HEADING	SOURCE	ACTION OR COMMENTS
ne	30° arc/sec	Unknown	180°	Varied	See Appendix I
ne	300-400 mph	1000'	160°	Sandia Base guard and wife	See Appendix II
ne	High	High	360°	Three airmen	No investigation
ne	Slow	High	Varied	Airman and WAF	Very probably a weather balloon
ne	948 mph	13,000'	340°	AC & W Sqdrn	See Appendix III
ne	Very high	Very high	315°	Retired Army Officer	No investigation
ne	High	Unknown	Varied	Commercial Pilots and ground observers	See Appendix IV
ne	Slow	10,000' at lowest point	None	Four airmen	No investigation - possibly balloon
ne	Hovering to high speed	Low to High	90°	Two ladies	See Appendix V
ne	High	Low	225°	AF Capt and wife	Pending
ne	Unknown	High	280°	Two airmen	No investigation - possibly balloon
ne	Erratic	Unknown	225°	AF Major	Pending
ne	High	Low	225°	AF 1st Lt	Pending
ne	High	Low	360°	Radar operator	See Appendix VI
ne	High	8,000'	Varied 180° to 90°	Two AF Pilots	See Appendix VI Believed to be balloon
ne	Low	93,000'	Unknown	Radar operator	See Appendix VI Was balloon
ne	140 mph	4,000'	Varied	GCA operators	Pending
ne	Slow	31,000'	Unknown	Radar operators	See Appendix VI Was balloon

DATE	TIME (Local)	LOCATION	DESCR
11 Sept 51	1330	Ft. Monmouth, N.J.	Radar Return (See Appendix VI).
12 Sept 51	0130	Cincinnati, Ohio	Dark bullet shaped object about the same
17 Sept 51	1217	Marion, Ohio	Pilot of Cessna reported that he almost c
18 Sept 51	0435 to 0531	Great Lakes Region	Air Defense Command radar stations tracked
23 Sept 51	1210	March AFB, Cal.	Object sighted over Long Beach. Four F-8 was unsuccessful due to altitude of objec
30 Sept 51	1500	Orange, Va.	Circular object which was sometimes encir
1 Oct 51	0415	Webster, Texas	Brilliant white light at a low altitude.
2 Oct 51	1945 and 2100	White Sands, New Mexico	Various "Fireball Type" objects were obse
2 Oct 51	1800	Columbus, Ohio	Bright circular object.
9 Oct 51	1342	Terre Haute, Ind.	Round, silver colored object passed over
9 Oct 51	1345	Paris, Ill.	Round, silver colored object seen by priv
11 Oct 51	0630	Minneapolis, Minn.	Round silver object seen by pilots tracki
11 Oct 51	Unknown	Lowell, Mass.	"Glittering object"
16 Oct 51	1101	McChord AFB, Wash.	Medium gray, round object. First sighted unsuccessful.
19 Oct 51	Unknown	Lenoir City, Tenn.	"Strange object"
21 Oct 51	1250	Battle Creek, Michigan	Disk-shaped object 30' - 40' in diameter. shaped with a highly polished surface.
22 Oct 51	1120	N. Truro, Mass.	Radar return - unidentified object.
7 Nov 51	0715	San Antonio, Texas	Unknown, high flying object reflecting su large meteor was seen in other parts of of the meteors looked like high flying

DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT

LENGTH
OF TIME
OBSERV

Appendix VI).	Several Minutes
object about the same size as a B-29. Red glow in front, white vapor at tail.	10 Sec.
reported that he almost collided with a black, high tailed swept wing aircraft.	Few Sec.
and radar stations tracked fast moving objects across Michigan and Wisconsin.	Approx. 1 Hr.
over Long Beach. Four F-86's scrambled and sighted object over Muroc. Intercept due to altitude of object. Orbited March AFB at 55,000' (See Appendix VII).	Unknown
which was sometimes encircled by a brownish haze.	Unknown
sight at a low altitude. Was generally stationary.	2 Hrs.
"Type" objects were observed.	Seconds
object.	15 Sec.
ored object passed over airport at high speed (See Appendix VIII).	15 Sec.
ored object seen by private pilot (See Appendix IX).	Unknown
ect seen by pilots tracking a balloon and by ground observer team (See Appendix X).	Several Minutes
6'	Unknown
and object. First sighted by theodolite crew. Intercept by four F-94's was	50 Min.
at 30' - 40' in diameter. Pilot in Navior met object head on. Object was disk- highly polished surface.	Unknown
identified object.	Several Seconds
ing object reflecting sun's rays. This incident took place at the same time a s seen in other parts of the S.W. The description is different, however, as none looked like high flying aircraft.	4 Min. 2 Sec.

DESCRIPTION OF INCIDENT	LENGTH OF TIME OBSERVED	SOUND	
	Several Minutes	None	S
same size as a B-29. Red glow in front, white vapor at tail.	10 Sec.	None	H
most collided with a black, high tailed swept wing aircraft.	Few Sec.	None	H
tracked fast moving objects across Michigan and Wisconsin.	Approx. 1 Hr.	None	H
in F-86's scrambled and sighted object over Muroc. Intercepted object. Orbited March AFB at 55,000' (See Appendix VII).	Unknown	None	U
encircled by a brownish haze.	Unknown	None	L
ude. Was generally stationary.	2 Hrs.	None	S
observed.	Seconds	None	H
	15 Sec.	None	H
over airport at high speed (See Appendix VIII).	15 Sec.	None	V
private pilot (See Appendix IX).	Unknown	None	V
tracking a balloon and by ground observer team (See Appendix X).	Several Minutes	None	H
	Unknown	Unknown	U
ghted by theodolite crew. Intercept by four F-94's was	50 Min.	None	G
	Unknown	Yes	U
eter. Pilot in Navior met object head on. Object was disk- ace.	Several Seconds	None	H
	4 Min.	None	2
ng sun's rays. This incident took place at the same time a ts of the S.W. The description is different, however, as none ying aircraft.	2 Sec.	None	V

LENGTH OF TIME OBSERVED	SOUND	SPEED	ALTITUDE	HEADING	UNCLASSIFIED SOURCE	ACTION OR COMMENTS
Several minutes	None	Slow	6000'	Unknown	Radar Operator,	See Appendix V
10 Sec.	None	High	20,000'	315°	One man, background unknown	No investigation
few Sec.	None	High	2800'	50°	Private Pilot	Probably friend conventional a,
Approx. 1 Hr.	None	High	Unknown	Varied	ADC Radar	Believed to be weather phenom
Unknown	None	Unknown	55,000'	Varied	F-36 pilots and ground observers	See Appendix V
Unknown	None	Low	Unknown	Varied	Letter from four teen- age boys	No investigati
2 Hrs.	None	Stationary	Low	None	Airman	No investigati
Seconds	None	High	High	Varied	Employees	No investigati
15 Sec.	None	High	Unknown	270°	Graduate Physicist	No investigati
15 Sec.	None	Very high	Unknown	135°	CAA Chief Aircraft Communicator	Very possibly See Appendix V
Unknown	None	Very high	5000'	45°	Private pilot	See Appendix I
Several Minutes	None	High	High	Unknown	Balloon observers	See Appendix I
Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Two children	No investigati
50 Min.	None	Great	High	270°	AF and Navy personnel	Proved to be
Unknown	Yes	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Letter from civilian	No investigati
Several Seconds	None	High	3000'	85°	Civilian pilot, 14 yrs experience	Pending
4 Min.	None	2070 mph	Unknown	135°	Radar operator	Indications o phenomena due weather.
2 Sec.	None	Very high	Very high	90°	City detective	No investigat

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Appendix I

LUBBOCK, TEXAS - 25 August 1951

The first of a series of sightings related to this incident occurred the evening of 25 August 1951 at approximately 2110 CST. Four Texas Technical College professors were sitting in the backyard of one of the professor's homes observing meteorites in conjunction with a study of micrometeorites being carried out by the college. At 2110 they observed a group of lights pass overhead from N to S. The lights had about the same intensity as a bright star but were larger in area. The altitude was not determined but they traveled at a high rate of speed. The pattern of the lights was almost a perfect semi-circle containing from 20 to 30 individual lights. Later in the evening a similar incident was observed and during a period of about three weeks a total of approximately twelve (12) such flights were observed by these men.

The group of men included:

- a. The Head of the Petroleum Engineering Department
- b. Professor of Geology, has Ph.D.
- c. Professor of Physics, has Ph.D.
- d. Professor of Chemical Engineering, has Ph.D.

Besides the above four men the following have observed the incidents:

- a. Professor of Mathematics, has Ph.D.
- b. Graduate student working on Ph.D.

In addition, a Professor of Astronomy was consulted on the incident, but he did not observe any of these flights.

The above mentioned men took a personal interest in the phenomena and undertook a study of the objects. Attempts were made to obtain an altitude measurement by laying out a measured base line perpendicular to the usual flight path of the object and placing angle measuring devices at the end of the base line, however, all their attempts failed because the objects did not appear on the nights the observers were waiting for them.

From the series of observations, the following facts were obtained:

- a. The angular velocity of the object was very nearly 30° of arc per second.
- b. There was no sound that could be attributed to the object.
- c. The flight path of the object was from N to S in the majority of the flights.
- d. There were two or three flights per evening.
- e. The period between flights was about one hour and 10 minutes.

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- f. The color of the lights was blue-white.
- g. There were from 20 to 30 separate lights in each formation.
- h. The first two flights observed were a semi-circle of lights but in subsequent flights there was no orderly arrangement.
- i. The object always appeared at an angle of about 50° from horizontal in the north and disappeared at about 60° in the south. The object did not gradually come into view as would an aircraft approaching from a distance, neither did it gradually disappear.
- j. There was no apparent change in size as the object passed overhead.

Attempts were made to obtain the relative height of the object in respect to clouds. However, these attempts were also unsuccessful due to the fact that the objects passed between widely scattered clouds.

Efforts to determine whether or not there was any form between the lights by trying to see stars between the lights were made. This also was unsuccessful due to the short time the object was in view.

This phenomena was observed by at least one hundred people in and around Lubbock, Texas. Some of these people were of the opinion that the objects were birds.

On the evening of 31 August 1950, at about 2330 CST, a college freshman from Texas Tech observed three flights of the object and allegedly obtained five photographs. He obtained two photos of one flight and three of another. These photos show single rows of light in V-formation on two photos and a double row on the others. His description of the object is much the same as that of the college professors, except that the college professors never observed a perfect V-formation.

(See Appendix II and V for possibly related incidents.)

Status of the Investigation

Project Grudge personnel made a trip to Lubbock, Texas, on 6-9 November 1951 to obtain more details on the incident. Many sources who had seen the object or who were involved in the sighting were interrogated. A conference was held with the college professors and they offered to write a detailed account of their observations and forward it to ATIC. This report should be forthcoming.

The photographer who claims to have photographed the object was interrogated. Every effort was made to find a flaw in the photographer's account of the incident but the results were negative. The college professors did not believe the photographs were authentic as they had never observed a V-shaped group of lights. They were not sure, however, whether or not they had observed the same objects that were photographed. Since the interrogation, two

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discrepancies in the photos have been found and the photographer is being reinterrogated by the O.S.I.

One school of thought of the people in the Lubbock area is that the objects were some type of migratory birds reflecting light from the city. Several people reported that they definitely knew the objects were ducks because they could see wings flapping. It is very possible that some of the people who were looking for the object did see ducks as there were duck flights passing over during the period. It is significant that those people who saw ducks were definitely able to identify the objects as ducks, or some type of bird, because they could see the wings or heard them make a noise, however, other people were just as determined that they were not birds. The possible conclusion is that some people did see birds, but others saw some other objects.

The college professors do not believe the theory that the objects were birds, but they are giving the possibility more thought. If they were birds, they would have to be relatively low to give the illusion of high speed. An occasional flight of birds might pass low over a city on a clear night but it is highly doubtful if they would continue to do this for several nights. Migratory birds usually try to keep away from cities.

The Federal Wild Life Game Warden was visited and although he was not familiar with the incident he doubted if the objects were birds. He stated that they could have been, however. The most likely suspect, if it is a bird, is a member of the Plover family which has a pure white breast, but unless there was a sudden influx of the birds into the Lubbock area, the game warden doubted if there would be enough of these birds to make up as many flights as were observed.

If the photos are authentic, the objects very probably are not ducks because an experienced photographer from the Lubbock Avalanche Newspaper attempted to get photos of ducks using both natural light and flash, but failed.

The investigation of this incident is continuing. It is probably the most unique incident in the history of Project Grudge in that it was observed so many times by a scientifically trained group of observers. These people are continuing to attempt to arrive at a solution for the phenomena. They had previously lost interest after several weeks of observations because they believed that the object was some new Air Force aircraft or missile.

The photographs are now at the Photographic Reconnaissance Laboratory at Wright Air Development Center for analysis.

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Appendix II

ALBUQUERQUE, NEW MEXICO - 25 August 1951

On the evening of 25 August 1951, at 2158 MST, a Sandia Base Security Guard and his wife observed what they described to be a flying wing type aircraft similar to the Northrop Fly Wing Bomber (B-49) pass over the backyard of their trailer home in the east part of Albuquerque. They judged the wing span of the aircraft to be about one and one half times the wing span of a B-36, with which they were familiar. The object was flying low, the altitude was thought to be about 800 ft. - 1000 ft., and there was no sound that could be attributed to the object. The color of the object was not apparent due to the twilight but dark chordwise stripes were noticed under the wings. Six to eight pairs of soft glowing lights were noticed on the trailing edge of the wing. The speed was judged to be about 300 - 400 mph and the object was on a heading of approximately 160°.

(See Appendix I for possible related incident.)

Weather

Broken clouds at 17,000 ft., visibility five miles, wind S at 5 mph.

Status of Investigation

The possibility of this being a known aircraft was checked with negative results. The AC and W Radar Station at Kirtland AFB did not observe any unusual or unidentified aircraft.

The guard's background was checked and since he has a "Q" clearance, it has been assumed that he is mentally stable.

The photos taken of the V-shaped object at Lubbock, Texas, (see Appendix I) were sent to Albuquerque. They were shown to the sources by the O.S.I. and sources stated that arrangement of lights on the object they saw was similar to the photo. They sketched in the wing as they saw it.

An investigation was made to determine whether or not any one else had seen the object but only negative results were obtained.

Further evaluation of this incident depends on the outcome of attempts to establish the authenticity of the Lubbock photos.

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Appendix III

LARSON AFB, WASHINGTON - 26 August 1951

On 26 August 1951 at 0836 PST, an unidentified flying object was detected by an AN/OPS-4 and AN/CPS-1 radar sets. The object was tracked continuously for a period of six minutes and made a timed ground speed of 950 mph. The object was on a course of 340° with only slight deviations enroute. An altitude reading of 13,000 feet was obtained but the accuracy of the measurement is questionable due to brief length of time the object was detected.

The F-86 aircraft were scrambled but radar contact with the object was lost before the aircraft were airborne. A visual search was conducted from 17,000 to 25,000 feet with negative results.

The operator of the radar set, an Air Force Captain, is considered to be an expert operator.

Weather

Weather conditions at the time of sighting were not favorable for anomalous microwave propagation.

Status of Investigation

Review of this incident by the Electronics Section of ATIC concludes that the return was possibly due to interference. This was concluded because of the apparent path of the object, directly approaching the station, and the fact that the target was observed on only the low beam of the AN/CPS-1 radar set.

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Appendix IV

VANDALIA, ILLINOIS - 27 August 1951

The only information available on this incident is a newspaper article from "Vandalia Leader" of 30 August 1951.

"It wasn't a flying saucer! Nor was it a conventional type airplane! But whatever it was, it has aroused the curiosity of at least five persons who saw it soaring through the air Monday night.

"It was a big orange light with blinding intensity when I first noticed it over the southwest corner of the airport," Ray Williams told the Leader. "I had just taxied out onto the runway preparing to take a flight around the city when I noticed the light. It was between 8 and 8:30 p.m. I called over the radio to the CAA official on duty Albert Dracklec, and to Paul Reese and asked them to take a look."

"The lighted object disappeared into the west and we decided maybe there was nothing to it. So I decided to continue with my flight plans," Williams stated.

"Shortly after I had taken off I noticed the light again, approaching my plane. It came directly at me and then circled my plane twice before heading toward Greenville. I followed it and it made a circle round that town and came back toward Vandalia. I last saw it near the country club. The CAA radioed a transport pilot who was passing over Vandalia at the time at about 20,000 feet and he too saw the object!"

"It was all very spooky," the Vandalia airman said. "It wasn't an airplane but whatever it was the light was on the tail of it, and there was a small red light on top. Probably it was some military craft from Scott Field making a test run."

"The lighted object which appeared to have a 10 to 12 inch lens, was also seen by Dwight Kerns in St. Elmo the same evening."

Status of Investigation

An attempt will be made to obtain further information on this incident.

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Appendix V

MATADOR, TEXAS - 31 August 1951

On 31 August 1951 at approximately 1245 CST two ladies were driving in an automobile several miles north of Matador, Texas. The object was described as a pear-shaped object, aluminum or silver in color, which readily reflected the sunlight. The object had a port or some type of aperture in the side. It moved through the air with the small end forward. They judged the size to be about that of a B-29 fuselage. There was no sign of any exhaust and no noise was heard.

As the two ladies were driving north from Matador, Texas, the driver of the automobile first noticed the object about 150 yards ahead of the automobile. They stopped and both ladies got out to observe the object. It was drifting slowly in an eastward direction at a speed they judged to be "less than the speed required to take off in a cub aircraft" and an altitude of about 120 ft. Seconds later the object began to ascent rapidly and in a few seconds it moved out of sight to the east in a circular ascent. (The wind at this time was from the NE at about 5-7 knots.)

A background investigation showed that both women were of excellent character.

This incident is of interest because it was observed during the same period as the objects over Lubbock, Texas, (see Appendix I).

Weather

a. 1230 CST - Reese AFB - 31 August 1951

Estimated ceiling 6,000 ft., broken clouds, with thin scattered clouds at 25,000 ft. Visibility 15 miles. Wind ENE at 3 knots.

b. 1230 CST - Childress, Texas - 31 August 1951

Estimated ceiling 25,000 ft., overcast. Visibility 15 miles. Wind NNE at 7 knots. Towering cumulus clouds in SE quadrant.

Status of Investigation

It has been reported that a road repair crew saw the same object later on the same day. Attempts will be made to contact members of this road crew and obtain their statements. There were also reports of crop dusting activity in the area, so attempts will be made to determine whether or not the ladies could have seen this activity.

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FORT MONMOUTH, NEW JERSEY - 10-11 September 1951

On 10 and 11 September 1951, a series of incidents occurred in the area of Fort Monmouth, N. J. An initial sighting of an unidentified object was made on a radar set. Soon after the radar sighting, two Air Force officers in a T-33 aircraft unsuccessfully attempted to intercept an unidentified object. Later several more radar sightings were reported.

Status of Investigation

A complete investigation of this incident was carried out and will be reported in Project Grudge Special Report No. 1. It has been tentatively determined that the T-33 pilots probably observed a balloon that had been launched a few minutes prior to their arrival in the area. Two of the radar sightings were returns from balloons and the others were probably due to weather phenomena and excitement of the student operators due to previous sightings. Only one radar return cannot be explained. The operator who observed this incident assumed the object was traveling over 700 mph because the radar set's automatic tracking would not follow the target. It is possible that the inability to track the object was due to his inability to properly operate the set under mental stress.

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Appendix VII

MARCH AFB - 23 September 1951

On 23 September 1951 at 0810 PST, an unidentified object was sighted over Long Beach, California. Four F-86 aircraft were scrambled and the object was sighted by them over Muroc, California. On attaining an altitude of 43,000 ft. the F-86's reported the object to be orbiting March AFB at an estimated altitude of between 50,000 ft. and 55,000 ft. The object appeared to be a swept wing, fighter type aircraft.

Weather

Unavailable at this time.

Status of Investigation

Radiosonde balloons were released from San Diego, Long Beach and Santa Maria, California at approximately 0700 PST. All of these weather stations were checked by OSI personnel and although the balloons were released all weather station personnel stated that it would be very doubtful if their balloons would have traveled the course that the object traveled.

All of the major aircraft factories and installations conducting experimental flight tests were contacted. No experimental aircraft airborne at the time of the sighting.

Additional information has been requested as to additional details of the incident such as times and locations during the attempted interception by the F-86's and other possible balloon launchings.

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Appendix VIII

TERRE HAUTE, INDIANA - 9 October 1951

On 9 October 1951 at 1342 CST, a CAA Chief Aircraft Communicator observed a silver object pass directly overhead while he was at Hulman Municipal Airport, five miles east of Terre Haute, Indiana. The object was judged to be approximately the same size as a 50 cent piece held at arm's length. The object passed overhead at a very high rate of speed going in a southeasterly direction, passing from directly overhead to the horizon in about 15 seconds. There was no sound or vapor trails. The shape and general form of the object could be seen as the object passed over the horizon and out of sight.

(For related incident, see Appendix IX.)

Weather

Clear, bright sun, no clouds or haze.

Status of Investigation

Further details on the incident will be obtained but it is doubtful if any further information will indicate the possible identity of the object.

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Appendix IX

PARIS, ILLINOIS - 9 October 1951

On 9 October 1951, at approximately 1345 CST, a private pilot en route from Greencastle, Indiana, to Paris, Illinois, sighted a silver object just east of Paris, Illinois, at 5,000 ft. altitude. The object appeared to be stationary in as much as it did not increase or diminish in size with the approach of the aircraft. The object then started to travel in a north-easterly direction south of the Newport, Indiana, Atomic Energy Plant.

(See Appendix VIII for related incident.)

Weather

Clear, bright sun, no clouds or haze.

Status of Investigation

More details of the incident will be obtained. Weather balloons are launched from Chanute AFB which is approximately 45 miles NW of the location of the incident. It is very doubtful if this object was a balloon as the balloon would have risen to a much higher altitude if it had drifted SE from Chanute AFB.

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MINNEAPOLIS, MINN. - 11 October 1951

The only information available on this incident is a letter quoted below.

"TIME: 0630, 11 Oct 51. Dick Reilly and I were flying at 10,000 ft. observing the grab bag balloon when I saw a brightly glowing object to the S.E. of U. of M. Airport. At that time we were a few miles north of Minneapolis and heading east. I pointed it out to Dick and we both made the following observation:

"The object was moving from east to west at a high rate and very high. We tried keeping the ship on a constant course and using reinforcing member of the windshield as a point. The object moved past this member at about 50 degrees per second.

"This object was peculiar in that it had what can be described as a halo around it with a dark undersurface. It crossed rapidly and then slowed down and started to climb in lazy circles slowly. The pattern it made was like a falling oak leaf inverted. It went through these gyrations for a couple minutes and then with a very rapid acceleration disappeared to the east. This object, Dick and I watched for approximately five minutes.

"I don't know how to describe its size, because at the time I didn't have the balloon in sight for a comparison.

"Shortly after this we saw another one, but this one didn't hang around. It approached from the west and disappeared to the east, neither one leaving any trace of vapor trail.

"When I saw the second one I called our tracing station at the U. of M. Airport and the observers there on the theodolite managed to get glimpses of a number of them, but couldn't keep the theodolite going fast enough to keep them in the field of their instruments. Both Doug Smith and Dick Dorian caught glimpses of these objects in the theodolite after I notified them of their presence by radio."

Status of Investigation

Further details of the incident have been requested. The sources have been investigated and are known to be experienced high altitude balloon observers with General Mills balloon projects.

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